Hearts on Fire

Forming Virtue, Mastering Self, Loving Deeply

Coach Joss & Coach Annie

SPEAKING VIRTUE

Focus Areas

- Discovering the Fire Within
- The Formation of Virtue
- The Misdirection of the Fire
- Emotional Maturity
- Desires: Fuel or Fire Hazard?
- Discernment
- Self-Mastery – Discipline of Fire
- Q & A (Group Session)

SPEAKING VIRTUE

Introduction

Deep within us, is a heart burning with passion for love, for fulfilment, for meaning and for truth.

Our heart is on Fire! For God has given us a heart that is alive.

To have a heart on fire means to be deeply alive; moved by passion, filled with conviction, stirred by truth, and ablaze with love for God and others.

This is the burning fire that ask to be enkindled by the Holy Invocation of the Holy Spirit. It is the fire that animated the saints, and martyrs.

That same fire is right with our hearts. Like every fire, this fire burns and if not formed, mastered, or rooted in God, can burn in the wrong direction.

Danger of Misdirection

When your heart is on fire, but your fire is fuelled by ego, culture, lust, or fear instead of Christ. You end up chasing:

- Attention instead of identity
- Romance instead of love
- Idolize instead of becoming an offering to God
- Self-Image instead of integrity

“There is a way which seems right to a man, but its end is the way to death.” – **Proverbs 14:12**

You have been called and chosen by God to run this race of life (cf. Hebrews 12:1–2).

Amidst the noise, fantasies, and pressures of today’s world that try to redefine you, you must stay the course.

You must finish this race well.

01

Desires

Fuel or Fire Hazard?

Desires – Fuel or Fire Hazard?

Let's be clear: **Desire is not your enemy**

"Delight yourself in the Lord, and he will give you the desires of your heart." – **Psalm 37:4**
"The desire for God is written in the human heart, because man is created by God and for God." – **CCC 27**

This fire within you, your passion, your longing for greatness, your hunger to be known and loved, was placed there by God.

God placed desire in your heart so you would seek Him, long for love, and be moved toward good.

The problem isn't desire; it's **disordered desire**. When fire is in the fireplace, it warms the home. When it's on the couch, it burns the house down.

When that fire is rightly formed by virtue, mastered by self-control, and driven by God's love, it becomes a force that not only purifies you, but sets the world on fire.
Let's learn to tend that fire, discern its purpose, and burn for something eternal.

Beware of the MINE Desire

Myopic Desires: These are short-sighted cravings that prioritize immediate pleasure over long-term purpose or virtue.

Individualistic Desires: These focus solely on personal gain or fulfilment, ignoring how our choices affect others or the common good.

Narcissistic Desires: These center on self-admiration and validation, often rooted in pride and an unhealthy need to be seen or praised.

Empty Desires: These are hollow longings for things that cannot truly satisfy the soul, like fame, wealth, or superficial longings.

02

Self Mastery

The Discipline of Fire

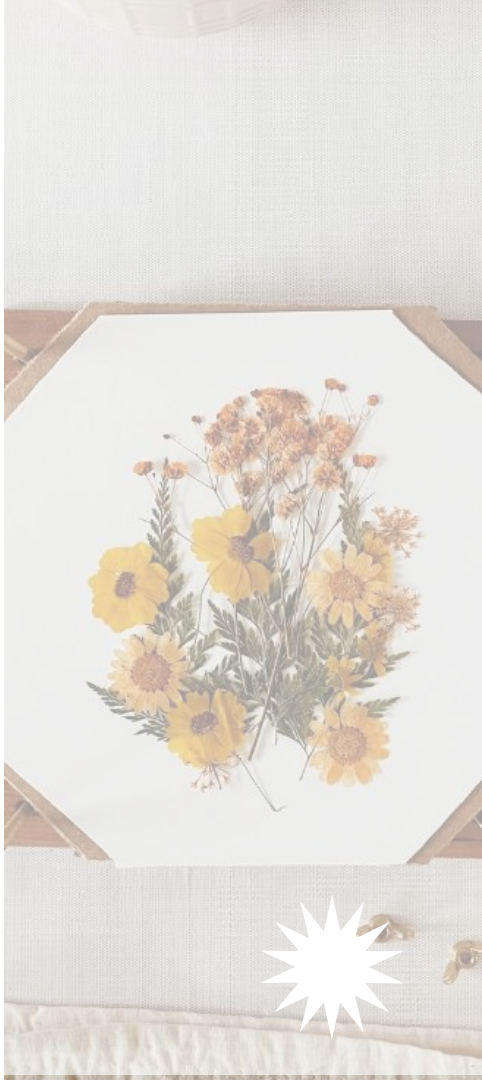
The Discipline of Fire

"Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God."

Matthew 5:8

"Chastity includes an apprenticeship in self-mastery which is a training in human freedom." – CCC 2339
"Self-mastery is a long and exacting work. It presupposes renewed effort at all stages of life." – CCC 2342
Self Mastery is not about denying every emotion. It's about choosing the greater joy over the present craving. (The illustration of the virtue of Chastity -Not Padlock but Key)

If you can't say no to your passion, you will soon loose even your will-power.



The Discipline of Fire

"The virtue of chastity blossoms in friendship… self-mastery prepares the way for deeper, faithful love." – CCC 2347

Here's how the CCC describes self-mastery:

- A lifelong effort (not a one-time achievement)
- A training ground for authentic love
- A foundation for freedom, because it allows the person to govern passions instead of being ruled by them

"The alternative is clear: either man governs his passions and finds peace, or he lets himself be dominated by them and becomes unhappy."– CCC 2339

03

Formation of Virtue

The Fire Under Control

The Formation of Virtue

"A virtue is a habitual and firm disposition to do the good. It allows the person not only to perform good acts, but to give the best of himself." (CCC 1803)

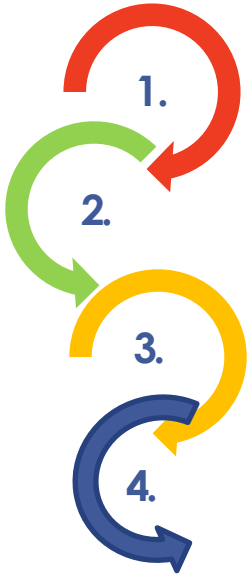
- **Temptation isn't sin** but entertaining it weakens your will.
- **Virtue isn't about being perfect**, it's about choosing the good again and again until it becomes who you are.
- *"Freedom consists not in doing what we like, but in having the right to do what we ought."* – St. John Paul II

Action Plan: Master Yourself: Sit with your Desires

- **Identify One Weak Spot**: What's the one habit, temptation, or attitude that keeps tripping you?
  Work on it with intention for 21 days.
- **Create a Virtue Plan:** Choose a virtue to grow in (e.g., patience, purity, courage).
  Read a Scripture or quote about it each week. Practice it daily. Journal your growth.
- **Fast from One Comfort:** Choose one comfort to give up for a week (e.g., scrolling, gossip, junk food).
  Replace it with silence, a Rosary, or Scripture.

Emotional Intelligence

Emotional Intelligence (EI) is the ability to recognize, understand, manage, and express your own emotions and to recognize, understand, and influence the emotions of others. There are four major components of EI:



1. **Self-Awareness**
2. **Self-Regulation**
3. **Motivation**
4. **Empathy**

"A man without self-control is like a city broken into and left without walls."
– *Prov 25:28 (RSV-CE)*

04

Discernment

The Fire with Purpose

The Fire With a Purpose

Discernment is a continuous, demanding, and grace-filled process of making choices in alignment with God's will, requiring self-knowledge, a deep relationship with God through prayer, and guidance from the Church and others.

- *“Each man must discover his vocation and carry it out with love, fidelity, and joy.”* – CCC 2230
  “Be who God meant you to be and you will set the world on fire.” – St. Catherine of Siena
- God’s will is not a riddle—it's a relationship. And He reveals it **step by step**, not all at once.

Benefits of Discernment:

- Discernment helps you understand God's will for your life.
- It helps you know what God has NOT called you to do.
- It saves you from living out of purpose and equips you to fulfill God's purpose for your life.
- It helps you understand how the Holy Spirit works through you.

"The more ready a man is to abandon himself to God's will, the more apt he is to discern it." – St. Ignatius of Loyola

Prayer of Re-Affirmation

Lord Jesus,

Rekindle the flame in my heart.

Purify my desires.

Strengthen my will.

Teach me to love deeply and purely.

Whether You call me to marriage, priesthood, or consecrated life,

I want to be Yours,

wholly and joyfully.

Help me form virtue, master myself, and love as You love.

Amen.

Thanks

Does anyone have any questions?